teams of specialists, then began a second round of negotiations.

In addition to nuclear missiles, we said we would try to reduce and eventually eliminate other nuclear weapons as well, including bombers, and Gorbachev pledged his commitment to strong and mutually acceptable verification procedures.

When I said we couldn't eliminate tactical battlefield nuclear weapons in Europe because they constituted NATO's principal deterrent against an invasion by the much larger Warsaw Pact conventional forces, Gorbachev volunteered drastic reductions in their conventional forces; this was something which we'd always considered a prerequisite to a nuclear arms reduction agreement, but never expected to get in Iceland.

George and I couldn't believe what was happening. We were getting amazing agreements. As the day went on I felt something momentous was occurring.

Our noon deadline came and went. We ignored the clock and kept on working, the four of us and our interpreters in that room above the sea.

As evening approached, I thought to myself: Look what we have accomplished—we have negotiated the most massive weapons reductions in history. I thought we were in complete agreement and were going to achieve something remarkable.

Then, after everything had been decided, or so I thought, Gorbachev threw us a curve. With a smile on his face, he said:

"This all depends, of course, on you giving up SDI."

I couldn't believe it and blew my top.

"I've said again and again the SDI wasn't a bargaining chip. I've told you, if we find out that the SDI is practical and feasible, we'll make that information known to you and everyone else so that nuclear weapons can be made